

Problem 5: When it clicks...

(18 marks)

Given below are 18 phrases in Xhosa⁷ and their corresponding English translations *in arbitrary order*.⁸

izitya ezinthathu, abantu ababini, umbuzo omnye, imibuzo emibini,
ilizwe elinye, imithi emithathu, umntu omnye, imibuzo emihlanu,
isitya esinye, ubomi, isitshixo esinye, ukutya, umfundi omnye,
izitshixo ezinthathu, ilikhaya elinye, abafundi ababini,
amakhaya amabini, ubuntu

three trees, one person, life, three dishes, one dish, two questions,
one country, one key, five questions, one student, three keys, food,
humanity, two people, one house, one question, two students,
two houses

Assignment 1: (9 marks)

Determine the correct correspondences.

Assignment 2: (3 marks)

Given that umfazi means “woman” and amazwi means “voices”, translate into Xhosa:

(a) three women

⁷Xhosa is a Nguni language spoken by around 10 million people and is an official language in Zimbabwe and South Africa.

⁸kh, tsh, th, and ty are single consonants. x is a click consonant, i.e. produced by clicking the tongue inside the mouth. The given data have been simplified from the original Xhosa for this problem.

(b) one voice

(c) womanhood

Assignment 3: (6 marks)

Explain how to translate such phrases into Xhosa.

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